

Univerzita Karlova
Fakulta sociálních věd
Institut politologických studií
Katedra mezinárodních vztahů

DIPLOMA THESIS PROJECT

Ontological Security of Bosnia



Name: Zachary Alan Stuck

Academic Advisor: doc. Aliaksei Kazharski, PhD.

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Introduction

Research Target & Question

This project focuses on the ontological (in)security of Bosnia and how political speeches impact a state's identity. Under the framework set forth by Mitzen (2006, p. 344), states are inclined to seek ontological security, which requires a collective identity that constitutes a state identity. This identity is shaped both internally and externally, but the aim of this research is to understand how the political speeches of Bosnia's politicians shape the identity of the Bosnian state and whether this strengthens or weakens the state's ontological security. The working hypothesis for this project are as follows:

H_1 : There are unified concepts used by politicians in their speeches, regardless of party, that shape the Bosnian state identity.

H_2 : Ontological security shapes the political discourse amongst politicians.

Literature Review

One of the primary works used for conceptualizing the theory of ontological security in regard to states is Jennifer Mitzen's (2006) 2006 article titled *Ontological Security in World Politics: State Identity and the Security Dilemma*. This article expands upon Giddens' (2009) work focusing on how individual identities are constructed, and she applies the concept to state actors as a direct response realist theorists (Mitzen, 2006, p. 342-344). Mitzen's (2006) application of ontological security is largely covered in the following theoretical framework section, but it created a framework that has been cited in much of the literature on this topic, including much of the literature cited in this project.

Conceptual & Theoretical Framework

Planned Outline

The proposed outline for this thesis is as follows:

- Introduction
- Theoretical Framework
- Methodology
- Data
- Empirical Analysis
- Conceptual Analysis
- Conclusion

Bibliography

GIDDENS, Anthony, 2009. *Modernity and Self-Identity: Self and Society in the Late Modern Age*. Reprint. Cambridge: Polity Press. ISBN 978-0-7456-0889-1 978-0-7456-0932-4.

MITZEN, Jennifer, 2006. Ontological Security in World Politics: State Identity and the Security Dilemma. *European Journal of International Relations*. Vol. 12, no. 3, pp. 341–370. ISSN 1354-0661, ISSN 1460-3713. Available from DOI: 10.1177/1354066106067346.